

Web services for Photographers

Photo albums and prints were means by which people relived their younger days and fond memories. Albums these days are virtual. Let's say, you're an amateur who's desperate to be called a *pro*. Or maybe you're a pro who wants the appreciation or criticism of peers. You may want your folks back home to see your new house, new friend or your new baby. And then again, maybe, you've got tons of images and you're fed up of juggling them in disk-hogging folders on your computer. For all of these problems, there's just one just place to go – cyberspace.

The World Wide Web has a plethora of services that allow you to store, exchange and do whatever a photographer would like to do with his/her photographs. Some of these are free and some come with a fee, but each one of them has something great to offer. This chapter is a handy guide to what these web sites have to offer.

13.1 Flickr (www.flickr.com)

One of the most popular photography sites, Flickr started off in February 2004 as part of a game developed by Ludicorp, Canada called 'Neverending'. However, Stewart Butterfield and his wife Caterina Fake realised pretty quick that they had a good thing going with this picture sharing software. They put an end to 'Neverending' and decided to develop Flickr as an independent entity. Their foresight paid off and today,